strategic interests. These attacks disrupt the mechanisms through which nonpopulist states exercise soft power, or influence others without resorting to coercion. This jeopardizes the benefits such states derive from the current global system.

Populists' attempts to dismantle IOs are not idle provocations; they are credible threats rooted in their pro-sovereignty, anti-elite ideology. Populist leaders are often rewarded domestically for resisting what they frame as overreaching or illegitimate IOs, making their opposition both ideologically consistent and politically advantageous. Such domestic pushback against IOs can harm their legitimacy and limit their ability to achieve their missions, especially during periods of crisis or upheaval when IOs become particularly salient in the public's minds (e.g., the WHO during the COVID-19 pandemic). Together, states and individuals that lead IOs have strong incentives to resist populist attacks, using the available tools and strategies to protect their organizations, maintain their missions, and uphold the international order.

1.5 IOs' Defensive Playbook

Given their agency and incentives, IOs are far from passive entities in the face of populist attacks. On the contrary, they possess a diverse set of tools with which to preserve their roles and influence on the global stage. While these strategies can be used against various types of opposition, this book focuses on how IOs employ them in concert to combat the unique, large-scale threat of populism. Unlike external challenges, which may call for different approaches, populism presents an internal, ideologically driven disruption that strikes at the very heart of IOs' missions.

Drawing from organizational sociology and international relations, we examine the defensive playbook of IOs, reimagining the classic tools of "carrots" (incentives) and "sticks" (punishments) for IOs. In organizational sociology, carrots and sticks are essential mechanisms for managing conflict and fostering compliance. Within IOs, these mechanisms can be tailored to meet the challenges posed by populist leaders and their constituents. Punishments are designed to sideline detractors and bring them back into compliance, while incentives aim to integrate hostile actors into the organization's norms and culture. Importantly, IOs wield these tools